

Subject: 🚀 [Launch Announcement] Well-Architected Skills & Steering for AI Coding Agents
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From: Cesar, Ibrahim
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LAUNCH ANNOUNCEMENT

Well-Architected Skills & Steering for AI Coding Agents

The **Developer Experience Pod** (part of the **Well-Architected Solutions Innovation Group**) published reusable skill files and steering rules that teach AI coding agents how to apply the AWS Well-Architected Framework as they write code. Works with Kiro, Claude Code, Cursor, Codex, Windsurf, GitHub Copilot, Gemini CLI, Antigravity, Cline and AWS DevOps Agent. Available today on GitHub: [aws-samples/sample-well-architected-skills-and-steering](https://github.com/aws-samples/sample-well-architected-skills-and-steering).

What is it?

A set of ready-to-use steering documents and skill definitions that developers drop into their AI coding agent's context. Once loaded, the agent provides Well-Architected guidance — surfacing best practices, flagging anti-patterns, and recommending pillar-aligned design decisions — directly inside the developer's workflow.

For customers, this means Well-Architected best practices are embedded where development actually happens — in the IDE, at the moment code is being written. Instead of treating architecture reviews as a separate gate, teams get continuous, contextual guidance that reduces rework, catches misalignments early, and accelerates adoption of the Framework without requiring deep expertise from every developer on the team.

This project grew out of a collaboration with **AWS Proactive Security**, who identified a clear need: internal builders, SAs, and customers were independently creating AI steering docs that didn't consistently align with the Well-Architected Framework.

Rather than let fragmentation continue, we built a single, canonical, framework-aligned source that anyone — internal teams and customers alike — can reference, share, and contribute to.

Why does it matter?

1. **Developers don't stop to consult documentation.** They ask their AI assistant. If the assistant doesn't know the Well-Architected Framework, the guidance never reaches the code.
2. **Shift-left on architecture quality.** Instead of catching issues in review, the agent raises them at authoring time — when the cost to fix is lowest.
3. **Agent-agnostic.** One set of skills works across 10 major AI coding tools. Developers keep their preferred editor and agent; we meet them where they are.

Who is this for?

- **Builders** who use AI coding agents daily and want Well-Architected guardrails without changing their workflow.
- **Solutions Architects** and **Technical Account Managers** who want to recommend a low-friction way for customers to adopt Well-Architected best practices.
- **Partners** delivering Well-Architected Reviews who want their development teams to proactively apply the framework during implementation.

How it works

1. Clone or download the repo
2. Copy the skill/steering files into your agent's configuration directory (e.g., `.kiro/steering/`, `.cursorrules`, `CLAUDE.md`, etc.)
3. For DevOps Agent: run `./install.sh ~/output -tool devops-agent` and upload the generated zip files to your Agent Space via the Operator Web App
4. Start coding — the agent now references Well-Architected best practices in its suggestions

No AWS credentials required. No API calls. Everything runs locally inside the agent's context window.

Link

- **GitHub repo:** <https://github.com/aws-samples/sample-well-architected-skills-and-steering>

Call to action

1. ★ Star the repo and try it with your preferred AI coding agent
2. Share with your customers and partners as a lightweight entry point to Well-Architected adoption
3. Open issues or PRs — contributions welcome from the community and internal teams alike

This is a **community-driven project**. Anyone — whether an external contributor or an internal AWS team — can collaborate and improve the skills and steering docs through Pull Requests. We encourage you to adapt them to your domain, add new patterns, and share back.

Acknowledgements

Org: Well-Architected Solutions Innovation Group

Developer Experience Pod: Charles Kim (chulhyun@), Tony Mangefeste (tonyman@), Duncan Bell (duncbell@), Ibrahim Cesar (ibracnb@), Jun-Tin (Bob) Yeh (bobyeh@)

Maintainers: Ibrahim Cesar (ibracnb@), Jun-Tin (Bob) Yeh (bobyeh@)

Sponsor / Requester: Mark Aiyer (markaiye@), AWS Proactive Security

Leadership Sponsor: Duncan Bell (duncbell@) and Haleh Najafzadeh (hnajafza@)

Content Guardian Reviewer: Stewart Matzek (smatzek@)

Questions? Reach out to Ibrahim Cesar (ibracnb@)

Ibrahim Cesar N. Bevilacqua – AWS

Well-Architected Solutions Architect

Thoughts on our interaction? Provide feedback [here](#).

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Feel free to read, act on, or respond at a time that works for you.*